Conversation track 8, 10, 11

Benedict and Celeste are getting married at a vineyard on Saturday. The nerves are kicking in.

Benedict: Bad news. It's **supposed to** bucket down on Saturday.

Celeste: Figures. Well, something was **bound to** go wrong. At least we've got the tent.

Benedict: True. And I've finished all the place cards. By hand.

Celeste: Oh, babe. Didn't I tell you? The venue prints them for free.

Benedict: You're kidding. So I **needn't have** stayed up till two?

Celeste: Oops, my bad. Hey, aren't you **supposed to** be writing your speech?

Benedict: Working on it. Your mum's **bound to** cry, whatever I say.

Celeste: She cries at commercials, so that's a given. Just keep it under five minutes.

Benedict: Five minutes? You're **supposed to** be on my side!

Celeste: I am. That's why I'm giving you a time limit.

Study Notes

It's supposed to bucket down on Saturday.
Nghe nói thứ Bảy trời sẽ mưa như trút nước.
"bucket down" (Anh, Úc, New Zealand) = mưa rất to. "be supposed to" ở đây nghĩa là "nghe nói, theo dự báo".
Cách nói tương đương: It's meant to pour on Saturday.

She cries at commercials, so that's a given.
Mẹ em xem quảng cáo còn khóc, nên chuyện đó khỏi phải bàn.
"that's a given" = điều hiển nhiên. "commercials" là từ Mỹ; người Anh hay nói "adverts".
Cách nói tương đương: That goes without saying.

Speak Like a Native track 9

1. You're kidding. So I needn't have stayed up till two?
change: "kidding" (i → ơ)
linking: "needn't_have", "stayed_up"
strong: "kidding", "needn't", "two"

Giọng New Zealand thường đọc /ɪ/ gần như "ơ": "cơ-đing". "have" đọc yếu /əv/, mất /h/: "ní-đơn-tơv". Lên giọng ở cuối vì bất ngờ.

2. Well, something was bound to go wrong.
change: "bound to" (mất âm d)
weak: "was", "to"
strong: "bound", "wrong"

"bound to" đọc thành "bao-nto". Chữ w trong "wrong" câm: /rɔːŋ/. Xuống giọng ở cuối, kiểu chán nản: biết ngay mà.

3. Hey, aren't you supposed to be writing your speech?
change: "aren't_you" (t + y → "ch")
weak: "to", "your"
strong: "supposed", "speech"

"supposed to" đọc liền, mất /d/: "sơ-pâus-tơ". Giọng Mỹ: "writing" → "rai-đing". Câu hỏi phủ định để nhắc khéo nên xuống giọng.

• Khi nói nhanh, /d/ giữa hai phụ âm thường mất: supposed to → "sơ-pâus-tơ", bound to → "bao-nto".
• "have" sau needn't, should, could đọc yếu /əv/: needn't have → "ní-đơn-tơv".
• Giọng New Zealand thường đọc /ɪ/ gần "ơ" (kidding, fish); giọng Mỹ đọc t giữa hai nguyên âm thành "d" nhẹ.
• Nhấn mạnh từ mang cảm xúc (needn't, two) để lộ vẻ tiếc công, ngạc nhiên.

Grammar Focus

be bound to / be supposed to + động từ nguyên mẫu

bound to: chắc chắn sẽ xảy ra. supposed to: lẽ ra phải (theo kế hoạch, quy định, vai trò), hoặc "nghe nói là".

Don't worry, they're **bound to** love you.
The bus **was supposed to** come at nine.
This film **is supposed to** be brilliant.

needn't have + V3 / didn't need to + V

needn't have: đã làm nhưng hoá ra không cần (tiếc công). didn't need to: không cần làm, thường là đã không làm. Người Mỹ ít dùng needn't.

You **needn't have brought** wine. We've got plenty.
I **didn't need to** queue, so I walked straight in.

Role Play track 13

A: Bad news. It's supposed to bucket down on Saturday.

B: Figures. Well, something was bound to _____. At least we've got the tent.

A: True. And I've finished all the place cards. By hand.

B: Oh, babe. Didn't I tell you? The venue prints them for free.

A: You're kidding. So I needn't have stayed up till two?

B: Oops, my bad. Hey, aren't you supposed to be _____?

A: Working on it. Your mum's bound to cry, whatever I say.

B: She cries at commercials, so that's a given. Just keep it _____.

A: Five minutes? You're supposed to be on my side!

B: I am. That's why I'm giving you a time limit.

Substitution Drill track 14

1. Well, something was bound to go wrong.
   a. come up
   b. go sideways
   c. slip through the cracks

2. Hey, aren't you supposed to be writing your speech?
   a. picking up your suit
   b. calling the band
   c. finishing the seating chart

3. Just keep it under five minutes.
   a. short and sweet
   b. clean
   c. light and funny